

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Myths From the Past



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Have you read stories or watched movies about vampires?
- What are vampires known for?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about strange events, sickness and problems.
- I can express possibility and certainty in written form.
- I can write about what was happening when something else happened.





Let's Explore!

Where do myths come from?



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Victims of hereditary disorders may have inspired tales of vampires. Throughout the centuries, myths have been used to explain the bizarre events and behaviors. Due to the lack of medical knowledge and a general fear of the unknown, communities would target and shun people who were different. It must have been a frightening time for people who knew little about human diseases. One such myth was the belief in vampires who would suck human blood and preferred to live in darkness. In fact, these were often people who were suffering from a rare hereditary illness called porphyria. *Porphyria* is the Greek word for "purple". A major symptom of the disease was that a victim's urine turned dark blue or purple in color because their body was struggling to produce heme, an essential component of red blood. There were other symptoms of the disease including extreme sensitivity to sunlight, sores and scars, excessive hair growth and tightening of skin around lips and gums. Changes to the mouth may have given sufferers a "vampire appearance".

Tragically, a common misconception was that when an individual ingested a healthy person's blood, they were replenishing the victim's own blood supply. Fear, ignorance of the disease and general intolerance often led to the persecution of many people. Victims of the disease must have felt isolated and misunderstood.

While sufferers lived as recluses, medical scientists were investigating the cause of the bizarre symptoms. They discovered that after they gave patients regular heme injections, they were seeing significant results. People who previously suffered from this condition were now living 'normal' lives instead of being condemned by their communities.





Let's Practice!

Is it a possibility or certainty?

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. tales / disorders / Victims / vampires / of / . / inspired / of / have / may
2. little / human / time / It / a / for / people / knew / who / frightening / must / have / diseases / . / been / about
3. a / mouth / may / "vampire / have / given / to / appearance" / . / sufferers / the / Changes
4. disease / must / isolated / and / the / . / misunderstood / Victims / of / felt / have



Let's Practice!

Let's talk about what happened in the past. Why were porphyria sufferers *recluses?

*A "recluse" is a person who lives in voluntary seclusion from the public and society.

Instructions: Complete the text with lived, were investigating, suffered, were seeing, heme, living, discovered, and condemned. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. People who previously _____ from this condition were now _____ 'normal' lives instead of being _____ by their communities.
2. While sufferers _____ as recluses, medical scientists _____ the cause of the bizarre symptoms.
3. They _____ that after they gave patients regular _____ injections, they _____ significant results.





Extension Activity

Time to learn more about myths from around the world.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and research a strange myth from the past.
- Write a 120-150 word paragraph about the myth you chose.
- Include a topic sentence, supporting sentences and a concluding sentence.
- Include the modals *might* and *may* to show possibility in your paragraph.
- Read your paragraph aloud to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I research myths from around the world.

☐ ☐

I write a paragraph about a myth.

☐ ☐

I read a paragraph about myths aloud to a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- vampire** (noun): a dead person who leaves the grave at night to bite and suck the blood of living people
e.g. Victims of hereditary disorders may have inspired tales of vampires.
- century** (noun): a period of 100 years
e.g. Throughout the centuries, myths have been used to explain bizarre events and behaviors.
- to shun** (verb): to avoid and reject
e.g. Communities would shun people who were different.
- myth** (noun): an idea or story that is believed by many people but that is not true
e.g. One myth was the belief in vampires who would suck human blood.
- to replenish** (verb): to fill or build up (something) again
e.g. They replenished the victim's own blood supply.
- heme** (noun): a component of red blood produced by the body
e.g. A victim's urine turned dark blue or purple in color because their body was struggling to produce heme.
- persecution** (noun): cruel or unfair treatment, especially because of race or religious or political beliefs
Example: Fear, ignorance of the disease and general intolerance often led to many people's persecution.
- to condemn** (verb): to give (someone) a usually severe punishment
e.g. The people were now living 'normal' lives instead of being condemned by their communities.
- misconception** (noun): a wrong or mistaken idea
e.g. Tragically, a common misconception was that when an individual ingested a healthy person's blood, they were replenishing the victim's own blood supply.
- hereditary** (adjective): characteristics that have been passed down by your parents
Example: These were often people who may have been suffering from a rare hereditary illness called porphyria.
- injection** (noun): the act or process of forcing a liquid medicine or drug into someone or something by using a special needle
e.g. Modern medical science now treats these patients with regular heme injections.





Learning Points

Modals for Possibility and Certainty

You use modals when you want to express possibility and certainty.

You use *may*, *might* and *could* to express possibility in the past and in the future.

*Might suggests that something is less possible than may

- might / might not + infinitive
- could / could not + infinitive
- may / may not + infinitive

Example:

*Fear and ignorance could have been the reason for the persecution of victims.
Communities may have thought that sufferers were dangerous.*

Expressing Certainty

You use *must* to express that something is necessarily true.

Example:

*She must have felt like he didn't care about her.
Victims of the disease must have felt isolated and misunderstood.*





Learning Points

Past Simple vs. Past Continuous

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about events that are finished. You use the Past Continuous to talk about events or an action that was happening at a time in the past.

Simple Past tense verbs can be regular or irregular.

Regular verbs end in *-ed* or *-ied*.

Irregular verbs change in different ways.

For questions in the past, you use the auxiliary *did* followed by the verb in the base form, like *Did you ask ... ?*

Did is the past form of *to do*.

For Past Continuous, we use *was/were* + verb.

Some verbs need a change to the last letter to add "ing".

Present	Past	Past Continuous
<i>look</i>	<i>looked</i>	<i>was/were looking</i>
<i>sit</i>	<i>sat</i>	<i>was/were sitting</i>
<i>read</i>	<i>read</i>	<i>was/were reading</i>
<i>apply</i>	<i>applied</i>	<i>was/were applying</i>
<i>type</i>	<i>typed</i>	<i>was/were typing</i>
<i>jump</i>	<i>jumped</i>	<i>was/were jumping</i>

Examples:

- Tragically, a common misconception was that when an individual **ingested** a healthy person's blood, they **were replenishing** the victim's own supply
- A major symptom of the disease was that a victim's urine **turned** dark blue or purple in color because their body **was struggling** to produce heme.